

Arike Palliative Home Care, Kochi
Newsletter
January 2025

As we step into 2025, we extend our heartfelt gratitude to everyone who has been part of our journey. Happy New Year! From all of us at Arike Palliative Care.

'My Santa 2024': A Symphony of Joy and Togetherness

The Christmas season is a time of joy, warmth, and togetherness. At Arike, we believe that no one should be left out of this celebration. Our Christmas Carol Programme '*My Santa 2024*' was an effort to bring the festive spirit to the homes of our palliative care patients. The Programme was held from 16th December to 21st December 2024 in the evenings. The bedside carols lit up the nights with festive melodies, filling each home with an atmosphere of celebration and joy. For many, it was a rare and cherished moment that brought comfort and happiness during a challenging time. Food kits, generously sponsored by donors, were distributed to the patients and their families. Cakes for the programme were sponsored by YMCA Ernakulam and Bhavan's Vidya Mandir, Girinagar. Beautiful festive cards to the patients were thoughtfully crafted by students from Vidyodaya School, Thevakkal, Bhavan's Vidya Mandir, Eroor and Nava Nirman Public School, Vazhakkala, adding a personal and heartwarming touch to the celebrations.

This year's programme was remarkable in the way it brought together individuals from all walks of life. Volunteers, students, donors, and community members joined hands to make the celebrations meaningful. Inspired by the efforts of Students' Initiatives in Palliative Care (SIP), partners such as Pavana Palliative Centre, Rajagiri College of Social Sciences (Autonomous), Kalamassery; Rajagiri College of Management and Applied Sciences, Kakkanad Government Law College, Ernakulam and Our Lady's Convent Girls Higher Secondary School, Thoppumpady, collaborated in this initiative. Together, they visited about 100 patients, spreading joy and warmth across homes in the region. The involvement of student volunteers from various colleges in Kochi brought enthusiasm, energy, and a sense of purpose to the celebrations. For these young individuals, this was not just a chance to give but also an opportunity to learn the values of empathy, kindness, and community service. Their cheerful presence and dedication keep inspiring all of us. Moreover, the collaborative efforts with institutions inspired by SIP demonstrated the profound influence palliative care initiatives can have on nurturing a sense of social responsibility in the younger generation.

Behind the scenes, the success of the Christmas Carol Programme was the result of meticulous planning and coordination. From identifying the patients to be visited to organising the volunteers and preparing the gifts, every detail was carefully managed by our team at Arike. The celebration would not have been possible without the kindness and generosity of our donors. We are deeply grateful to everyone who supported this initiative, whether through financial contributions or by giving their time and energy. As we move forward, we remain committed to spreading care and light to those who need it most. Thank you for being a part of this beautiful journey. Together, we continue to make a difference.



Activities

Arike Review Meeting

On December 14th, a review meeting of volunteers and team members was held at the Arike Conference Hall in Palarivattom. The session provided a platform for participants to share insights, assess the standard of care delivered, and discuss any care-related difficulties. Encouraging open communication, the meeting aimed to address challenges collaboratively while incorporating expert recommendations to enhance practices. Koode fosters a reliable support network for patients, their families, and caregivers.



Christmas Celebration at IMA

On December 18, 2024, a Christmas celebration was organised for the staff at Arike at IMA. The celebration provided an opportunity for staff members to bond, reflect on the year gone by, and strengthen their camaraderie.



Arike Electric Wheels

Arike received an electric car donated by IMA Kochi in collaboration with Kochi Shipyard to support its palliative care activities. Dr. S. Harikrishnan, Executive Director (Shipbuilding), Kochi Shipyard, flagged off the vehicle during a formal event.

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DESHABHIMANI

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അരികെ പാലിയേറ്റീവ് കെയറിന് ഇലക്ട്രിക് കാർ

കൊച്ചി

പാലിയേറ്റീവ് കെയർ പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങൾക്കായി ഐഎംഎ കൊച്ചി, കപ്പൽശാലയുമായി സഹകരിച്ച് അരികെ പാലിയേറ്റീവ് ഹോം കെയറിന് ഇലക്ട്രിക് കാർ സമ്മാനിച്ചു. കലൂർ ഐഎംഎ ഹൗസിൽ നടന്ന ചടങ്ങിൽ കൊച്ചി കപ്പൽശാല എക്സിക്യൂട്ടീവ് ഡയറക്ടർ (ഷിപ്പ് ബിൽഡിങ്) ഡോ. എസ് ഹരികൃഷ്ണൻ വാഹനം ഫ്ലാഗ്

ഓഫ് ചെയ്തു.

പൊതുനന്മ ഫണ്ട് മേധാവി പി എൻ സമ്പത്കുമാർ, മാനേജർ എ കെ യുസഫ്, ഐഎംഎ കൊച്ചി സെക്രട്ടറി ഡോ. സച്ചിൻ സുരേഷ്, ഡോ. അതുൽ ജോസഫ്, ഡോ. ജൂനൈദ് റഹ്മാൻ, ഡോ. ജോർജ് തുകലൻ, അരികെ പാലിയേറ്റീവ് കെയർ പ്രവർത്തകർ തുടങ്ങിയവർ ചടങ്ങിൽ പങ്കെടുത്തു.



പാലിയേറ്റീവ് കെയർ പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങൾക്കായി കൊച്ചി ഐഎംഎ കൊച്ചി കപ്പൽശാലയുമായി സഹകരിച്ച് അരികെ പാലിയേറ്റീവ് ഹോം കെയറിന് നൽകുന്ന ഇലക്ട്രിക് കാർ കൊച്ചി കപ്പൽശാല എക്സിക്യൂട്ടീവ് ഡയറക്ടർ (ഷിപ്പ് ബിൽഡിങ്) ഡോ. എസ് ഹരികൃഷ്ണൻ ഫ്ലാഗ് ചെയ്യുന്നു.

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IAPC State Volunteer Meet

The Indian Association of Palliative Care (IAPC) State Volunteer Meet was held in Kottayam from December 27 to 29, 2024. Representatives from Arike actively participated in the event. A presentation on the Arike Model was delivered by Dr. George Tukan. The meeting was inaugurated by the Honourable Health Minister of Kerala, Ms. Veena George, and saw the participation of numerous volunteers from across the state. The event provided a platform for exchanging ideas, sharing best practices, and strengthening volunteer networks within the palliative care community.



Awareness Programmes

On 5th December 2024, an awareness session was conducted at Bhavan's Vidya Mandir, Girinagar marking the beginning of our December outreach activities. The students actively participated, engaging in discussions about the role of palliative care and how young minds can contribute to fostering a compassionate society.

On 11th December 2024, the team conducted another session at Government Law College, Ernakulam. The session inspired law students to consider volunteering for palliative initiatives, and their enthusiastic response was commendable.

On 14th December 2024, we engaged with the Lajna Imaillah Residents Association, Kacheripady, for an interactive session. Participants appreciated the emphasis on community support and caregiving at home. They raised several insightful queries, reflecting their keen interest in making a difference locally.



On 15th December 2024, an awareness session was held at the Kadavanthra Residents Association, where participants learned about basic caregiving techniques and ways to emotionally support patients and their families. The session concluded with a vibrant discussion, showcasing the community's readiness to extend their support.

On 22nd December 2024, a session was conducted at the Government Higher Secondary School, Pezhakkappilly, focusing on introducing students to the values of empathy and care.

The enthusiastic response from the students and their thoughtful questions were truly inspiring.



On 24th December 2024, the team visited the National Service Scheme (NSS) Camp at Government Law College, Ernakulam, to guide young volunteers on their role in community service. The session encouraged the students to actively engage in spreading awareness about palliative care in their networks.



On the same day, on 24th December 2024, a session at St. Peter's Vocational Higher Secondary School, Kolenchery, focused on the care needs of palliative patients and scope of student involvement. The students displayed immense interest and shared their ideas on how they could contribute to creating a compassionate community.



‘Koodē’: Building a Community of Compassionate Care

As we step into 2025, we reflect on the strides made through ‘Koodē’, our community palliative care initiative launched as part of the Palliative Action Plan, 2023. ‘Koodē’ is dedicated to ensuring that every homebound patient has access to at least one volunteer, bridging the gap between patients and the care they need.

In 2024, we conducted **36 awareness sessions**, reaching out to over **2000 people** in and around Kochi city. Through these sessions, we sensitised individuals about palliative care, identified potential volunteers, and provided them with training to create a strong, well-connected volunteer network. This initiative has strengthened the bond between patients and volunteers, ensuring that no patient feels isolated in their journey.

We sincerely thank all the institutions and associations for allowing us the opportunity to conduct awareness sessions and to strengthen the ‘Koodē’ initiative. Your support, combined with the enthusiasm of volunteers, donors, and participants, has made a tangible difference in the lives of many. We thank every individual who joined hands with us in this effort, and we look forward to scaling these efforts in the year ahead, ensuring that every patient in need feels supported, cared for, and valued.

Sensitisation Programmes and Stalls

On 8th December 2024, a sensitisation stall was set up at IMA *Thanima*, where our team engaged visitors in conversations about Arike’s work and the significance of palliative care.

Many attendees expressed their interest in supporting our mission, making it a meaningful experience for all involved.

On 9th December 2024, we participated in the ASTA Annual event at St. Teresa's College, setting up an interactive stall. The students showed keen interest in learning about Arike's palliative care initiatives and exploring ways they could contribute as young volunteers.

On 13th December 2024, Arike was part of the WEN Carnival, where our stall became a platform for diverse discussions. Visitors resonated with the stories of care we shared, and many were inspired to join the palliative care movement.



On 17th December 2024, a sensitisation session was held at IMA WIMA, focusing on Arike's comprehensive palliative care model. The participants, including medical professionals, appreciated the emphasis on interdisciplinary collaboration and holistic care approaches.



On 18th December 2024, another sensitisation effort was held during IMA General Body at Kaloor.

Food Kit Distribution

On December 19, 2024, Arike distributed food kits to patients at their homes with the support of volunteers. This initiative aimed to provide essential supplies to patients who might otherwise face challenges in accessing them. The smooth execution of the distribution was made possible by the proactive participation of volunteers.

Let's Talk: Daily Discussions on Palliative Care

'Let's talk' is a daily review to discuss the needs and treatment plans of our palliative care patients. Join our virtual meet-ups to collaborate, share insights, and improve the quality of care we provide.

Support Our Cause

We warmly encourage you to contribute to Arike, enabling us to make a meaningful and lasting difference in the lives of individuals requiring palliative care.

Payments can be transferred to our account.

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Bank name: Federal Bank

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A/C Name: Arike Day Care Nurses

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Branch : Palarivattom

Federal Bank

arike9765@fb1

